

Ankit Raj

Senior Solutions Architect - Data & AI, Lakehouse & GenAI

Stockholm, Sweden | rajankit749@gmail.com | ankitraj.cloud | linkedin.com/in/raj-ankit | github.com/restlessankyyy

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior Solutions Architect and strategic technical advisor with 10+ years in client-facing roles, leading the most complex data and AI engagements across the Nordics. I establish data platforms on greenfield and enterprise accounts - assessing architectures end to end and guiding stakeholders from data and AI practitioners up to C-level. Deep expertise across the data landscape: data engineering, data warehousing, lakehouse, real-time analytics, MLOps, and GenAI, with a hands-on AI-Builder mindset (multi-model orchestration, RAG, LLM evaluation). Proven at influencing VP+ leaders, creating structure in ambiguous, fast-moving situations, and moving customers beyond proof-of-concept to measurable business outcomes - 35% cost reduction, 70% latency reduction, 99.9% reliability for 200+ teams. I thrive in rapid-growth environments, abstract my builds into reusable patterns for the wider community, and coach fellow architects to maintain high standards at sustained velocity.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Data & Analytics	Lakehouse Architecture, Data Engineering, Data Warehousing, ETL/ELT, Real-Time Analytics, Microsoft Fabric, BigQuery, Databricks, Delta Lake concepts, Pub/Sub, Dataflow
AI & GenAI (AI-Builder)	GenAI/LLM Strategy, RAG, Multi-Model Orchestration, Agentic AI (MCP), MLOps, Prompt Engineering, Vertex AI, Microsoft Foundry, OpenAI, Claude, Gemini
Technical Strategy	Greenfield Account Strategy, Architecture Assessment, Multi-System/Multi-Account Design, Reference Patterns, Adoption Signals, Measurable Outcomes
Executive Advisory	Trusted Advisor to VP+ & C-Level, Stakeholder Alignment, High-Tension Negotiation, Executing Through Ambiguity, Pre-Sales & PoC to Production
Cloud Platforms	AWS, Microsoft Azure, Google Cloud - Architecture, Migration, Governance & FinOps at Scale
Engineering & Infra	Distributed Systems, Microservices, Serverless, Kubernetes (AKS/GKE), Terraform, GitHub Actions, CI/CD, Spark-based pipelines
Leadership	Mentoring & Coaching Architects, Technical Discovery, Use-Case Prioritisation, Thought Leadership & Reusable Patterns
Languages	Python, SQL, TypeScript, JavaScript, Go, Scala (familiar)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Lead Cloud Architect - Data & AI Platforms 2024 - Present

H&M Group, Stockholm

- Lead technical strategy for strategic data and AI initiatives, acting as trusted advisor to VP+ and BU leaders and driving alignment across competing constraints and evolving goals for 200+ product teams
- Architected enterprise AI and data platforms on Microsoft Foundry, GCP Vertex AI, and AWS Bedrock - multi-model orchestration, RAG, and agentic AI (MCP tools) for incident response and governance, with an AI-Builder, hands-on approach
- Assessed customer and platform architectures end to end, addressing problems spanning multiple systems, teams, and stakeholders from practitioners to C-level, and drove RFP/cloud-strategy decisions (AWS vs Azure)
- Moved initiatives beyond proof-of-concept to measurable outcomes - 35% cloud cost reduction via FinOps and Azure Fabric analytics, using adoption signals to ensure sustained impact
- Abstracted builds into reusable reference patterns, blueprints, and best-practice guidance adopted across the wider engineering community
- Coached and mentored 8+ engineers and architects on technical discovery and use-case prioritisation, maintaining high standards at sustained velocity

Lead Software Engineer - Data Platform & Analytics 2023 - 2024

H&M Group, Stockholm

- Engineered the data and cloud backbone on Azure & Google Cloud, building data pipelines and analytics foundations with Azure Fabric, governance, and self-service access for 200+ teams
- Designed and built an Internal Developer Platform with self-service provisioning (EventGrid + Functions), reducing onboarding from days to minutes and accelerating data product delivery
- Evaluated and benchmarked OpenAI, Claude, and Gemini LLMs for developer experience - shipping GenAI productivity solutions that improved team velocity by 40%
- Led enterprise architecture using SAP LeanIX, Zachman, and TOGAF, aligning data and platform decisions with long-term business strategy

Senior Software Engineer - Distributed Systems & Data 2020 - 2023

H&M Group, Stockholm

- Designed distributed, high-throughput systems - 15+ microservices and GraphQL/REST APIs handling 50K+ RPM with sub-100ms p99 latency across a multi-cloud data landscape
- Built a multi-cloud API and data-access platform with Azure Gateways on GKE, with automated scaling, rate limiting, and reliable data flows
- Led CI/CD standardisation with GitHub Actions across 200+ repositories - 95% pipeline success rate, establishing engineering best practices at scale
- Identified emerging reliability risks early and mobilised teams to act, resolving complex cross-system issues through root-cause analysis

Cloud Solutions Architect Consultant - FSI Data & AI 2019 - 2020

Cognizant - Ikano Bank, Stockholm

- Strategic technical advisor to a financial services client - architected migration of AML & KYC data and APIs from on-premises to a serverless, event-driven platform, reducing latency by 70%
- Designed scalable data and integration architecture (Lambda, API Gateway, DynamoDB, Step Functions) handling 500K+ daily transactions with Terraform IaC and CloudWatch observability
- Designed a scripted, rules-based automation framework for code and API policy conversion - reusable IP that cut migration delivery time by 60% through templated, repeatable tooling
- Delivered executive proof-of-concept demonstrations, driving alignment and commitment for full cloud and data adoption under shifting priorities

Cloud Solutions Architect Consultant - Automotive 2019 - 2020

Cognizant - Volvo Cars, Gothenburg

- Trusted technical advisor to engineering teams - designed and delivered an enterprise observability and analytics platform (ELK, Grafana, Prometheus) on AKS monitoring 100+ microservices
- Managed CI/CD pipelines for OpenShift & Kubernetes with Azure DevOps - reduced deployment cycle time from hours to 15 minutes
- Authored architecture documentation and runbooks - achieving 99.5% SLA compliance and translating requirements into measurable outcomes

Cognizant Technology Solutions

- Designed AWS cloud and data architectures for 5+ enterprise clients - CI/CD with CodePipeline, Docker, ECS/Fargate in client-facing consulting roles across diverse verticals
- Built a React-based Cloud Management Dashboard with real-time infrastructure and cost analytics, and automated policy governance across AWS & Azure
- Won 1st place at Enterprise AWS Game Day 2018 (200+ participants) and led knowledge transfer to client teams

KEY DATA & AI PROJECTS

Enterprise AI Platform - Multi-Model Orchestration (H&M Group)

Designed distributed AI orchestration serving 200+ teams - multi-model inference, A/B evaluation, and RAG with auto-scaling. Microsoft Foundry, Vertex AI, OpenAI, Python, TypeScript. Reusable patterns for community adoption.

Enterprise FinOps & Analytics Platform (H&M Group)

Multi-agentic AI system on Azure Fabric analytics reducing multi-million SEK cloud spend. Automated anomaly detection, right-sizing, and governance dashboards across AWS, Azure, and GCP - measurable, sustained outcomes.

AML/KYC Serverless Data Migration (Ikano Bank, FSI)

Architected migration of regulated AML/KYC data and APIs to serverless. Scripted, rules-based automation framework for code and API policy conversion. 70% latency reduction, 60% faster delivery through templated, repeatable tooling.

Rubin - Local AI Coding Assistant (Open Source)

Privacy-first local AI assistant with 14-tool agent mode, MCP server integration, and streaming chat. Demonstrates GenAI product thinking and hands-on AI-Builder depth. TypeScript, Ollama, VS Code API.

CERTIFICATIONS

- AWS Certified DevOps Engineer - Professional
- AWS Certified Developer - Associate
- Microsoft Certified Professional (MCP) - Exam 533: Azure Infrastructure
- Microsoft Certified: Azure Fundamentals (AZ-900)
- Microsoft OpenHack: AI-Powered Knowledge Mining · Containers · Security, Compliance & Identity · DevOps
- Google India Udacity Scholar

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Technology - Computer Science & Engineering

Galgotias University, Greater Noida, India

2012 - 2016

Specialisation in Cloud Computing & Virtualisation. Projects: IoT Heart Rate Monitor, Big Data Analytics for Twitter.

PUBLICATIONS & THOUGHT LEADERSHIP

Google Just Compressed AI to 3 Bits - Deep dive into TurboQuant KV cache compression (Medium)

I Gave an AI Agent Root Access to a Sandboxed Linux Box - AI agent experimentation (Medium)

Why FinOps Is Failing the Enterprise - Enterprise cloud cost governance (Medium)

What is Kubernetes? - Container orchestration deep-dive (FAUN / Medium)